

IAM Architecture and Stakeholder Mapping

WEEK 1 OF 5 – SIMPLIFYIAM LIVE COHORT

Saturday, May 9, 2026 | 1:00 PM CEST · Srinath



Before We Start

Who is in the room

How this works

Each Saturday builds on the last. You are not watching – you are doing. Every task is something a real consultant does on a real engagement.

What you are building toward

A working IAM implementation you can demo, explain, and defend in an interview. Not a certificate. Evidence.

□ **This session is personalised. The more you engage, the more useful it becomes.**



Your Mission for the Next 5 Saturdays

You are **not** a student following a tutorial. You are an **IAM consultant delivering a real engagement**.

Client

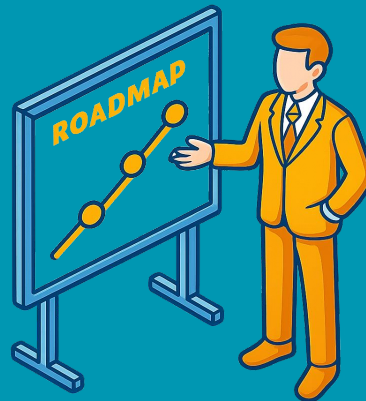
SimplifyTech – a 200-person technology services company with a manual identity problem.

Problem

HR updates a spreadsheet. IT manually creates accounts one by one. Nobody knows who has access to what.

Your Job

Design and build their identity infrastructure from scratch over five consecutive Saturdays.



- 📅 **By Saturday 5** you present the completed implementation as a formal client handover – the same deliverable a real IAM consultant submits at the end of an engagement.

Why Most People Get Stuck in IAM

The IAM job market rewards practitioners, not theorists. Three traps keep talented people from breaking through.



Theory Trap

Knows *what* provisioning is.
Cannot build a pipeline. Can describe the concept in an interview but freezes when asked to show it.



Cert Trap

Passed SC-300 or similar.
Never configured a connector.
Certification validates knowledge – it does not validate delivery.



Demo Trap

Watched every vendor video.
Cannot troubleshoot in production. Demos are scripted. Real projects are not.



Companies do not pay for what you know. They pay for what you can build and prove.

IAM Is Not One Thing

IAM is an umbrella term covering four distinct disciplines. Confusing them is one of the most common mistakes in the industry.



IGA

Identity Governance & Administration – who has access, joiner/mover/leaver provisioning, access certifications, role management.



PAM

Privileged Access Management – admin accounts, service accounts, just-in-time access, session recording. CyberArk, BeyondTrust.



Access Management

SSO, MFA, Federation – how users authenticate after accounts are provisioned. Okta, Entra ID, Ping.

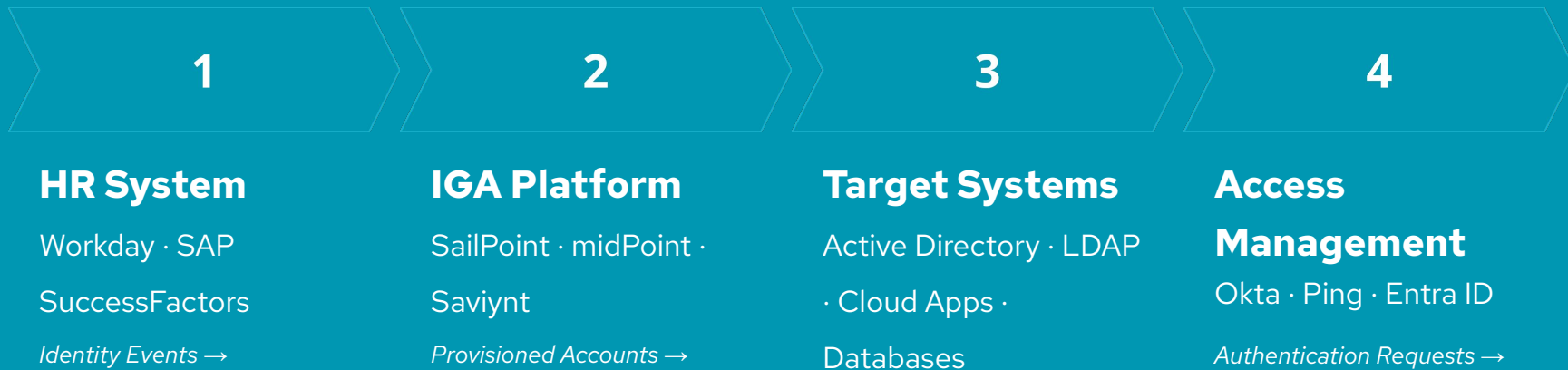


CIAM

Customer Identity – external users, B2C flows, self-registration, consent management. Auth0, Okta CIAM.

This cohort covers **IGA (Weeks 1–3)** and **Access Management / CIAM (Week 4)**.

Enterprise IAM Architecture



i IGA Platform is the central orchestration layer – it receives identity events, enforces policy, and pushes provisioned accounts to all connected systems.

Customer Identity & Access Management (CIAM)

The customer identity journey – from first visit to authenticated session.

External Users

Customer-facing entry points

New Visitor

Returning Customer

Partner User

Self-Registration →

Social Login (Google · Apple) →

Passwordless MFA →

User Profile Store

Consent Management

Session Management

Token Issuance

Downstream Systems

Web Application

Mobile App

API Gateway



Audit & Compliance

All authentication events, consent records, and session activity logged for regulatory compliance (GDPR · CCPA · SOC 2)

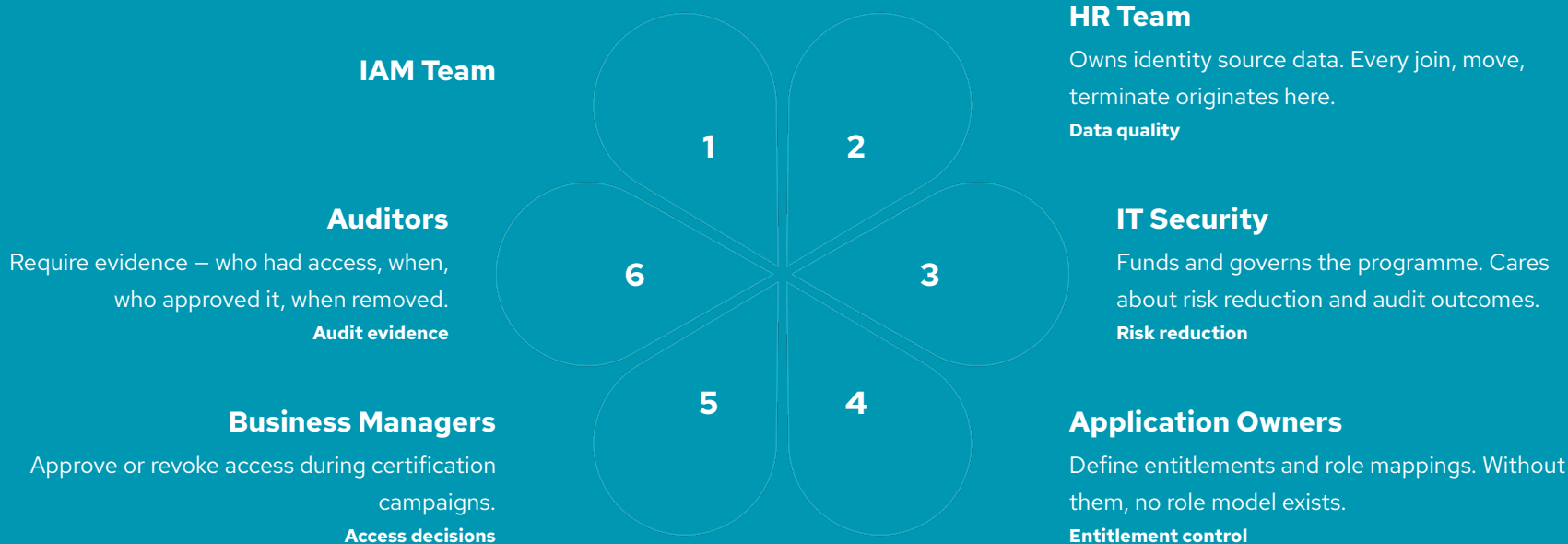


CIAM governs who buys from you – not who works for you. Scale, trust model, and UX requirements are fundamentally different from enterprise IAM.

*We cover CIAM hands-on in Week 4

IAM Stakeholder Map

Five groups. Five motivations. One implementation team at the centre.



Your job is not just technical. You must speak five different languages – data, risk, entitlements, decisions, and evidence – fluently.

Every Stakeholder Speaks a Different Language

Your job as an IAM implementer is to translate between business language and system behaviour – fluently, in both directions.

Joiner Scenario

HR says: "The employee starts on Monday."

IT hears: "Create the account now."

IAM translates: Trigger joiner workflow, provision to all target systems, assign role based on department and title – before Day 1.

Mover Scenario

Business says: "Remove John's access – he moved to Finance."

IT hears: "Update his permissions."

IAM translates: Run mover workflow, remove Engineering role, assign Finance role, reconcile all connected systems.

Audit Scenario

Auditor says: "Show me who had access to this system on March 15th."

IT hears: "Check the logs."

IAM translates: Pull provisioning audit trail, certification history, and access review results with timestamps.

Your job as an IAM implementer is to translate between all three – in real time, under pressure.



Your Client – SimplifyTech

Size

200 employees – technology services firm.

Current State

Manual everything. HR spreadsheet. IT creates accounts one by one. Zero audit trail. Zero governance.

Trigger

Failed their first SOC2 audit. New CISO hired. You are brought in as the IAM implementation partner.

Your Mandate

Build automated identity infrastructure in 5 weeks. Demonstrate it. Hand it over.



Every decision you make over the next 5 Saturdays is a decision a real IAM consultant makes on a real project. The tools are simplified. The thinking is not.

What SimplifyTech Actually Needs

Identity Source

HR spreadsheet today.
Need a system of record that IGA can read automatically. No manual exports.

Target Systems

Active Directory equivalent for all staff accounts. Every employee needs a directory account on Day 1.

Lifecycle Automation

Joiner, Mover, Leaver must be triggered by HR events – not IT tickets. Zero manual provisioning.

Audit Trail

SOC2 requires evidence of who had access, when it was granted, when it was removed, and who approved it.

 **Before you configure a single connector – you need to understand what you are solving for. This is the requirements conversation you have with the CISO in week one of a real engagement.**

How You Actually Gather Requirements

Five workshop sessions, each with a different stakeholder group.

Workshop	With Who	What You Are Extracting
Discovery	CISO / IT Security	Trigger, scope, compliance drivers, budget reality
HR Workshop	HR Team	Employee data structure, what fields exist, data quality issues, how often it updates
Application Workshop	App Owners	Which systems need accounts, what roles exist, who approves access
Business Workshop	Department Managers	How do joiners get flagged, who approves movers, what is the leaver process today
Audit Workshop	Compliance / Auditors	What evidence is required, retention periods, who needs to sign off access reviews



You do not learn requirements from a document. You extract them from conversations. Each workshop produces a different artefact that feeds directly into your design.

Requirements Drive Every Architecture Decision

Requirement

HR as identity source

Directory for all staff

Automated lifecycle

Audit trail

No manual provisioning

Architecture Decision

CSV connector from SimplifyHR

OpenLDAP as target system

midPoint JML workflows

midPoint audit logs

Reconciliation tasks on schedule



Every component in your lab exists because of a requirement. Nothing is arbitrary. This is how you explain your architecture decisions in an interview.

Real IAM. Real Client. Real Workshop Notes.

In Module 1 Lesson 3 you will find anonymised notes from a live IAM engagement. Three workshops. Real stakeholders. Real open questions that were still unresolved at Workshop 3.

Read it before Week 2 and answer the three questions in your Lab Journal.



This is what your work looks like on a real project. Not a tutorial. Not a demo. A live engagement.

Start With an MVP – Not a Full Rollout

Weeks 1–2 of a real engagement

One HR source connected

One target system (AD /
LDAP)

Joiner and Leaver automated
for one department

Basic audit logging confirmed

CISO can see it working

Full Implementation

Weeks 3 onwards

All target systems connected

Role model built with app
owners

Mover workflow with role
transition logic

Access certification
campaigns live

SOC2 evidence package ready



The MVP proves the architecture works and keeps the client confident. You are building the SimplifyTech MVP over five Saturdays. By Week 2 the CISO can see accounts provisioning automatically. That is the moment the project gets full buy-in.

Your SimplifyTech Lab Stack

Three components. One automated flow. This is exactly what enterprise IAM looks like at its core.

1

SimplifyHR

Flask web app

HR source of truth

Port 8085

2

SimplifyIAM (midPoint)

IGA platform · provisioning engine

Port 8080

3

OpenLDAP (389 DS)

Target directory

phpLDAPadmin

Port 389 · 8089

SimplifyHR – **CSV feed** → SimplifyIAM

SimplifyIAM – **Provisioned accounts** → OpenLDAP



HR feed (CSV) flows into SimplifyIAM. SimplifyIAM provisions accounts automatically into OpenLDAP. No manual steps. No scripts. No exceptions.

Your Lab – Three Components, One Flow

Open all three in your browser now. Confirm they load. Post in chat: **ready**



SimplifyHR

[http://\[your-ip\]:8085](http://[your-ip]:8085)

Employee data source. This is where all identity events originate.



SimplifyIAM (midPoint)

[http://\[your-ip\]:8080/midpoint](http://[your-ip]:8080/midpoint)

IGA platform and provisioning engine. The brain of your identity stack.



phpLDAPAdmin

[http://\[your-ip\]:8089](http://[your-ip]:8089)

Visual interface for OpenLDAP. Watch accounts appear here after provisioning.



All three components are pre-deployed in your lab environment. If any tab does not load, post your IP address in chat and we will troubleshoot together.

SimplifyTech Before You Start

This is the clean state. By Week 5, every blank will be filled – automatically, consistently, and auditably.

SimplifyHR

6 employees loaded and ready:

**Sophie, James, Laura, Thomas,
Emma, Oliver**

This is your source of truth. All
identity events begin here.

SimplifyIAM

Platform is running. But:

No resources configured.

No connectors set up.

No synchronisation tasks defined.

OpenLDAP

Directory is running. OUs are created
and structured. But:

Zero user accounts exist yet.

Waiting for its first provisioning
event.

 **Week 2: you connect all three components from scratch. Today: you understand the architecture deeply enough to build it next week.**

Architecture Decision 1

Why one IGA platform – and not a collection of scripts?

The Script Approach

- Breaks silently in production with no alert
- No reconciliation – drift goes undetected
- No audit trail – cannot answer "who did what, when?"
- No certification – cannot run access reviews
- One developer knows how it works. They leave. It stops.

The IGA Platform Gives You

- **Correlation rules** – prevents duplicate identity creation
- **Conflict detection** – flags unexpected changes in target systems
- **Entitlement governance** – tracks every access grant and removal
- **Certification campaigns** – periodic access reviews with business sign-off
- **Audit logs** – immutable record of every provisioning action

Scripts create accounts. IGA manages identities. These are different problems.

Architecture Decision 2

Why OpenLDAP in the lab – and not Active Directory?

In the Real World

Active Directory (or Azure AD / Entra ID) is in virtually every enterprise environment. It is the dominant directory service globally.

In Your Lab

OpenLDAP (389 DS) is free, open source, runs on Linux, and implements the same LDAP protocol. No Windows licence. No domain controller required.

What Transfers Directly

- Every concept learned on OpenLDAP applies directly to Active Directory → `dn, ou, cn, objectClass, attributes` – identical concepts, different flavour
- LDAP bind, search, modify, delete operations – same across every LDAP-compliant directory

✓ **You are learning the protocol, not the product. That is what makes you vendor-neutral and more employable.**

Architecture Decision 3

Why CSV as the HR source – and not a live API?



Master the concept with the simplest possible tool. Then apply it anywhere. A CSV connector and a Workday REST connector teach you the same mental model.

Real World

Workday REST API, SAP SuccessFactors OData, Oracle HCM – each has its own connector, authentication scheme, and pagination logic.

Your Lab

CSV file updated by the SimplifyHR Flask app. Simple, transparent, debuggable – you can read the source data directly.

Why It Transfers

The connector concept is identical. midPoint reads a CSV the same way SailPoint reads a Workday API endpoint. Different connector, same architecture: **source** → **mapping** → **target**.

Two Documents to Download Now

Lab Implementation Journal

Your personal record of every week. Fill it in during and after each session. Week by week tables for what you built, decisions made, issues solved, and interview talking points. By Week 5 you have a complete answer bank for any IAM interview.
Download from Module 0 in the classroom.

GitHub Portfolio Guide

Step by step from zero to a public portfolio. Everything done from your browser – no Git CLI needed. Includes a README template, screenshot checklist, and the exact script to use when an interviewer asks about your experience.
Download from Module 0 in the classroom.



These are not optional extras. They are your evidence. The Lab Journal becomes your interview prep. The GitHub repo becomes your portfolio. Both are useless if you do not fill them in.

Before Next Saturday

Three actions. Non-negotiable. These build the habit of treating every session as a professional engagement.



Lab Journal – Week 1

Fill in the architecture section of your Lab Journal. Document the decisions made today: why IGA over scripts, why OpenLDAP, why CSV. Record any open questions.



GitHub Repository

Create your portfolio repository following the GitHub Portfolio Guide in Module 0. This is where every artefact from Weeks 1–5 will live. Future clients will look at this.



Community Screenshot

Post your first screenshot in SimplifyIAM Pro – your lab dashboard showing all three components running. This is your first public proof of work.



These three actions compound over five weeks. By Week 5 you will have a journal, a portfolio, and a public track record – not just a completion certificate.

What This Looks Like in an Interview

The Question

"Walk me through how you would implement a Joiner workflow."

Without This Cohort

Describes the concept from memory. Talks through the theory. Maybe draws a diagram. Interviewer has heard it fifty times before.

With This Cohort

Opens screen share. Loads SimplifyIAM. Adds a new employee in SimplifyHR. Runs reconciliation. Shows the account appearing in OpenLDAP **in real time**. Explains every decision made along the way.



**You do not describe IAM. You demo it. That is the difference.
That is what gets you hired.**

Next Saturday – You Build the Plumbing

Week 2 is where the architecture becomes real. You will not be watching a demo – you will be driving.

01

Delete the pre-existing config

Start from a genuinely clean state. No scaffolding. No shortcuts.

03

Map HR attributes to identity attributes

Define inbound mappings: firstName, lastName, department, jobTitle → midPoint focus object properties.

05

Run your first reconciliation

Watch the six SimplifyTech employees appear in OpenLDAP automatically. Your first live provisioning event.

02

Connect SimplifyHR to SimplifyIAM from scratch

Configure the CSV connector resource manually – resource URL, schema, attribute definitions.

04

Configure correlation rules

Prevent duplicate accounts by telling midPoint how to match incoming HR records to existing identities.

06

Build the Leaver pipeline

Configure the termination-to-disabled workflow end-to-end. Terminate an employee in SimplifyHR, watch the account disable in seconds.



Come to Week 2 with your lab accessible and all three browser tabs ready to go.

Q&A – Bring Your Real Questions

We coach as a group because **someone else's question is almost always your question too.**



Where Do I Fit in IAM?

Career changers, IT generalists, developers, auditors – IAM has a path for each. Let's map your background to the right entry point.



I Have an Interview Coming Up

Bring the job description. We will work through what they are actually testing for and how to position your lab work as real experience.



I'm Stuck on Something Technical

Lab not behaving as expected? Connector not loading? Reconciliation returning errors? We debug together – that is how real IAM teams work.



What Should I Focus on Next?

Not sure whether to go deeper on IAM, pivot to PAM, or start targeting certifications? Let's look at your situation and build a short-term plan.



No question is too basic. The most common questions in this room are the ones nobody asks in public. Ask them here.